

Bible online

Parts of the bible are available online, nearly 1600 years after they have been written. High res copies of gospel of Mark, several books of the Old Testament and commentaries related to these works will be hosted by the University of Leipzig which has the custody of the originals.



Twreleased

When an American researcher and his translator were arrested by Egyptian authorities, Twitter turned unlikely rescuer. A post by the student alerted the American embassy and secured his release; a Twitter campaign led to the release of the translator after three months of torture.

twitter

Enter

POWER THROUGH PAPER

A Paper Transistor Now!

A team of researchers from Universidade Nova de Lisboa, Portugal, has come up with an innovative way to use paper as the primary component in Field Effect Transistors (FETs).

This technology uses substrates glass or crystalline silicon as a substrate. Similarly, with the help of biopolymers, costs can be further reduced. With cellulose being such a common resource, several studies have pointed to using it as a support material for electronic devices.

The new device, not only functions as the substrate, but also works as an insulator. The researchers have fabricated the devices on both sides of the paper sheet. As a result, the paper acts as an insulator and substrate at the same time. Paper, a known cellulose, also has decent electric insulation and dielectric properties. Therefore, to create the new device, a team led by Elvira Fortunato and Rodrigo Martins from CENIMAT/I3N, used a single sheet of common paper as a dielectric layer on which semiconductor oxides were printed.

The findings would most likely be published coming September, which hopefully would boost

commercial interest. The new transistor closely resembles oxide thin film transistors in terms of electrical characteristics and way over those of TFTs fabricated out of amorphous silicon substrates. The results suggest that in the near future, disposable electronic devices, paper displays, smart labels, smart packaging, bio-applications, RFID tags and many more could become a reality. Especially, in the case of consumer grade devices where even a few grams count, paper based circuits will be a hit as they will be considerably lighter than all the conventional devices like mobiles and cameras are made up of. Being paper, the circuits can be folded, further reducing the size, while being more environmentally friendly at the same time.

STALLMAN BLASTS GATES

Picking On Gates

Richard Stallman, founder of the Free Software Foundation feels that people are paying too much attention to the retirement of Microsoft Chairman and co-founder



Bill Gates. Stallman is of the opinion that people should focus their attention to the unethical restrictions that Microsoft, like many other software companies, imposes on its customers, rather than paying attention to the leadership of the software company.

This is the latest in Stallman's long standing debate against restrictions that prevent software from being shared, modified, and distributed without a license. Now with most geeks turning to open source and appreciating Linux forte, Stallman's call would have many takers and supporters. He criticised the software company for lack of interoperability and said it seems that the main advanced Windows Vista made was to increase user restrictions. Well, it seems true, but he could have been a bit more subtle.

Accusing Microsoft of engaging in anti-competitive behaviour, he targeted Gates' efforts that claim to help the poor. He said only five to 10 per cent of the money from the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation funds causes, and the remainder is invested in companies for personal coffers. Stallman's fight for free software has become personal for years now. The founder of the GNU Project and Free Software Foundation picked at Gates about three years ago, when Gates defended software patents and used the term *communist* to characterise those who oppose proprietary software. Stallman has named Microsoft, as well as Apple and other software companies, while criticising the proprietary system that he says equates acts of sharing with attacking a ship.